
TOUCH OF THE SOUTH

Island Express, *Kanyakumari, Tamil Nadu – Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala*



No one really knows why this train is called the Island Express, for it does not cross an island at any point in its journey from Kanyakumari, on the southernmost tip of the country to Thiruvananthapuram, in Kerala, God's own country. It is not an official name either, but is entrenched in public memory. It is possible that this happened sometime in the 1960s, when

the train began its journey from Willingdon Island, an artificial island in Kerala. Travel by the train as it makes its slow, meandering journey past quaint stations, palm trees, tiny temples and, as the train crosses into Kerala, churches that dot the landscape. This is the best way to experience the heart of southern India.